



**POPE LEO IN
LOURDES:
'PRAY THE ROSARY
IN OCTOBER FOR
PEACE'**

At the concluding Mass in Lourdes, on the third day of his Apostolic Journey to France, Pope Leo XIV launched an appeal that he said was "particularly close to my heart, here in this place." Just as the Blessed Virgin Mary appeared to St. Bernadette in the Grotto of Lourdes with a Rosary and guided her in prayer, the Pope said he hopes all Christians will pray the Rosary *especially during the month of October*. He called for them to pray the Rosary "with the particular intention that wars may cease and that peace may be established among peoples in conflict." Pope Leo said: "Let us accompany this prayer with concrete acts of penance and mercy, committing ourselves always to fostering dialogue and reconciliation".



**Feast of Our Lady of the Rosary
7th October 2026**

WEEKEND MASS INTENTIONS

Recently Deceased

Brian O'Farrell, Malahide, late of Portmarnock

Saturday, 3rd October – 6.30pm

Marie Fagan & Family,[A];
Bridie McRory & Family,[A]
Dave O'Shaughnessy & Family, [A];
Brian O'Reilly, [Anniv];
Maria Bertha Da Silva,[5th A]

Sunday, 4th October – 10.30am

Joan Morris,[16th A]; Anne Carroll,[A];
Barry Cox,[2nd A].

12 noon

Verona Connolly,[RD]; Barry Cox,[2nd A].

COLLECTIONS

Common Fund € 1,363
Share € 515
Sincere thanks for your support

PORTMARNOCK LIONS CLUB

Will hold a Church gate Collection on the weekend of the 3rd / 4th October

NEW PARISH FINANCE COMMITTEE

First meeting of the new Parish Finance Committee will take place n Monday, 5th October at 7.15pm in the Library, Parish Centre.

**MEETING OF THE PARISH
PASTORAL COUNCIL**

will be held on Monday, 12th October at 7.30p.m. in the Library, Parish Centre

Archdiocese of Dublin

**Discover the gift that God
has placed within you!**

"Every vocation begins with the discovery that we are loved by God, and becomes a path of joy when we respond with trust and generosity"
POPE LEO XIV



If you would like to find out more about being a diocesan priest serving in the Archdiocese of Dublin, please contact:

Fr Séamus McEntee Director of Vocations vocations@dublindiocese.ie
Fr Bill O'Shaughnessy Assistant Director of Vocations bill.oshaughnessy@dublindiocese.ie

www.dublindiocese.ie/vocations

Building Hope

Fifteen new students have begun their training for the priesthood for the academic year 2026 – 2027. In total, there are now 74 seminarians in formation training to minister for Irish dioceses, and these are: 15 entering their Propaedeutic Year in various seminaries; 51 are studying in the national seminary of Saint Patrick's College, Maynooth, and at the Redemptoris Mater Seminary in Dundalk; and, 8 are based in seminaries on the continent.

**THANK YOU - AFTERNOON CLUB
HOSPICE COFFEE MORNING**

The amount collect at the St Francis hospice coffee morning was €3384.23

a huge thank you to all who supported, donated and baked.

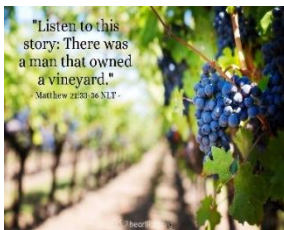
**ST ANNE'S CHURCH, PORTMAROCK
CELEBRATION OF & FIRST HOLY COMMUNION &
CONFIRMATION 2027**



St. Helen's JNS
First Holy Communion
15th May 2027
St. Marnock's
First Holy Communion
22nd May 2027



St. Helen's SNS
Confirmation
15th April 2027
St Marnock's
Confirmation
22nd April 2027



**Make Jesus Christ known
and loved, authentically,
passionately, again and
again."**

Today's Gospel contains a simple message: "the kingdom of God will be given to a people who will produce its fruit." These are certainly need many gifts in our church today. Saint John Henry Newman, who will be proclaimed a Doctor of the Church by Pope Leo on All saints Day November 1st, wrote a famous poem called Lead Kindly Light:

"Lead, Kindly Light, amid the encircling gloom, lead Thou me on. The night is dark, and I am far from home. Lead Thou me on. Keep Thou my feet, I do not ask to see the distant scene, one step enough for me".

At times in our lives when the way ahead on our journey of faith can seem to be unclear, these words of Newman may be a source of inspiration and encouragement. Certainly, in our church today, at a time much change and the headwinds of society often against us, it helpful to realise that many good Christian people had these challenges before us and prevailed to a lesser or greater extent. It is at times like this that we can echo the words of the apostles to "increase our faith." And the best way to increase our faith may be to allow additional time in the presence of God. This may be few minutes of quiet prayer at the beginning or end of the day or perhaps

to attend mass whether in person or online depending on our circumstances. It may also be possible for us to enjoy an autumn walk and to appreciate the beautiful colours of this time of the year. The poet John Keats described autumn as the "season of mists and mellow fruitfulness". Autumn is the time for the harvest, the gathering of crops into barns as preparations are made for the coming winter. In some churches there is a celebration of the harvest festival as we thank God for the gift of the food that we eat. Speaking in Lourdes last week Pope Leo said: "To renew hope and give fresh impetus to the church's mission in France, which I earnestly desire, there is only one 'road map,' which is always the same: to make Jesus Christ known and loved, authentically, passionately, again and again." He added: "The church has every right to be heard in the public square. By its nature, it possesses a prophetic authority. Even if it is not always understood, her voice is nonetheless needed." Finally, these words of Pope Leo resonate with me as we are currently assisting six adults who are part of our Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults (RCIA) programme: "I too believe that the time is ripe for many in our society who are waiting to hear the hope-filled message of the Gospel and see the light of the risen Christ shine before their eyes." Let us all reflect on how best we can increase our own faith in the circumstances of our own lives. This is a good time to look forward to a future that is certainly going to involve creative thinking and innovative ideas. When I think of previous generations in our parish, I can say that what distinguished them was there faith and hope in the Risen Lord. Let us ask them all to inspire us from their place in the house of the Father as we step into their shoes and rise to face the challenges of our times.

Deacon Gerard



PORTMARNOCK SCOUTS

Will host their *Annual Sleep Out against Homelessness* with Focus Ireland 'Shine a light' in the grounds of St. Anne's Church, Portmarnock
On Friday, 9th October.
Your support would be welcome